

KINEXUS SYSTEMS

THE EXPORT READINESS PLAYBOOK

A practical, step-by-step guide for Punjab & Haryana manufacturing MSMEs preparing for their first — or next — international shipment.

Covers: documentation & compliance · quality systems · digital traceability · FTA opportunities · common rejection reasons · a 20-point self-assessment



Why Export Readiness Matters Now

India's expanding network of Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) — including with the UK, UAE, EFTA and the EU negotiations underway — is opening tariff-advantaged access to new markets for manufacturers across bicycle & auto parts, pharmaceuticals, scientific instruments, sports goods, textiles, agro-processing and engineering goods. For MSMEs in Punjab & Haryana, this is a genuine growth opportunity — but only for units that can demonstrate consistent quality, traceable production records, and clean compliance documentation.

This playbook distills the most common gaps we see during Technology Readiness Assessments (TRAs) into a practical checklist you can work through with your team. It is organised around the same Crawl-Walk-Run-Fly (CWRF) framework Kinexus uses for digital maturity — because export readiness and digital readiness are, in practice, the same journey.

How to use this playbook

Work through each section with your production, quality and accounts leads. Tick off what's already in place. Items left unchecked are your priority list — start with Section 1 (documentation), since it underpins everything else.

Core export documentation

- Importer-Exporter Code (IEC) issued and active with DGFT
- RCMC (Registration-cum-Membership Certificate) from the relevant Export Promotion Council
- GST registration with export/LUT (Letter of Undertaking) filed for zero-rated supply
- Standard commercial invoice and packing list templates, consistent across orders
- Certificate of Origin (CoO) process identified for your target FTA (UK, UAE CEPA, EFTA, ASEAN, etc.)
- HS codes verified and documented for every product line you intend to export

Product & sector-specific compliance

- BIS / sector-specific certifications identified for target markets (e.g. CE marking for EU, FDA registration for pharma/medical devices)
- Test certificates and lab reports filed digitally and retrievable within minutes
- Material composition declarations (especially for textiles, sports goods, toys) ready for buyer audits
- REACH / RoHS compliance documentation in place if exporting to EU markets
- Halal / Kosher or other market-specific certifications obtained where relevant to your buyer base

Banking & payments

- Authorised Dealer (AD) Code registered with your bank for export transactions
- Process defined for Letter of Credit (LC) document handling and discrepancy resolution
- Export incentive schemes (RoDTEP, Duty Drawback) understood and claim process assigned to someone

International buyers — especially in regulated sectors like pharmaceuticals, auto components and scientific instruments — routinely audit suppliers before placing first orders. A documented, demonstrable quality system is often the single biggest differentiator between MSMEs that win export contracts and those that don't.

Quality management foundations

- ISO 9001 (or sector equivalent: ISO 13485 for medical devices, IATF 16949 for auto, WHO-GMP for pharma) certified or in active certification process
- Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) documented for key production and QC steps — not just known by senior staff
- Incoming raw material inspection records maintained and retrievable by batch
- In-process quality checkpoints defined with recorded pass/fail data, not just verbal sign-off
- Final inspection and pre-shipment QC checklist used consistently across all export orders
- Non-conformance and corrective action (NCR/CAPA) process documented, even if simple

Buyer audit readiness

- Factory floor walkthrough doesn't reveal undocumented or informal processes that contradict your SOPs
- Calibration records for measuring/testing equipment are current and accessible
- Worker training records maintained for quality-critical roles
- A designated person can produce any requested quality record within the audit window, not days later

Traceability — the ability to track a product from raw material to shipped order, and reconstruct that history on demand — is increasingly a hard requirement for export buyers, not a nice-to-have. It's also the foundation that everything in the Kinexus CWRF framework builds on.

Crawl: Get the basics digital

- Production logs, inventory counts and order records exist in structured digital form (spreadsheets are fine to start) rather than only paper registers
- Each batch or production lot has a unique identifier that appears on related QC and dispatch records
- Raw material lots are recorded against the finished goods batches they were used in

Walk: Connect the records

- Inventory, production and order records are linked so a single update doesn't create discrepancies elsewhere
- A single dashboard or shared view lets you answer 'where did this batch's materials come from, and where did the finished goods ship to?' within minutes
- Quality records (test certs, inspection results) are tagged to the same batch/lot identifiers used in production and dispatch

Run & Fly: Automate the trail

- Export documentation (CoO, packing list, invoice, test certs) can be assembled from existing digital records with minimal manual re-entry
- Automated alerts flag missing documentation or quality sign-offs before a shipment is scheduled to leave
- Historical traceability data can be exported into a buyer-ready format on request, without a multi-day scramble

FTA Opportunities by Sector

India's recent and ongoing FTAs create tariff advantages that can materially change your competitiveness in specific markets. The table below highlights opportunities particularly relevant to manufacturing clusters across Punjab & Haryana.

Sector / Cluster	Relevant FTAs	What it means for you
Bicycle & Auto Parts (Ludhiana, Rajpura)	UK FTA, UAE CEPA	Reduced tariffs on components into UK and UAE markets; CoO documentation becomes critical
Pharmaceuticals (Baddi, BBN belt)	UAE CEPA, EFTA	Market access gains contingent on WHO-GMP and regulatory dossier readiness for export
Scientific & Surgical Instruments (Ambala)	EU negotiations, UK FTA	CE marking and ISO 13485 increasingly determine which buyers will even consider a supplier
Sports Goods (Jalandhar)	UK FTA, EU markets	Material compliance (REACH) and social compliance audits are common pre-conditions
Textiles & Hosiery (Ludhiana)	UK FTA, EFTA	Tariff reductions favour units that can document fibre composition and meet sustainability standards
Agro Processing & Food (Karnal, Kurukshetra)	UAE CEPA, ASEAN	Food safety certification (FSSAI export standards, HACCP) and traceability are typically required

Note: FTA provisions and rules of origin change periodically. Always verify current tariff schedules and rules of origin for your specific HS codes with DGFT or your export promotion council before quoting buyers on FTA-based pricing.

Common Export Rejection Reasons & Fixes

Rejection Reason	Typical Root Cause	Fix
Inconsistent product specifications across batches	No standardized SOP; tribal knowledge varies by shift	Decide on SOPs for critical specs; record actuals per batch, not
Missing or incomplete test certificates	Testing done but records not filed systematically	Tag every test record to a batch ID; centralise in one digital folder
Packaging doesn't meet buyer/market requirements	Packaging designed for domestic market only	Build a per-market labelling checklist before first shipment; review
Delayed shipment due to documentation errors	Too many people assembling manifests	Build templates per buyer/market; assign one owner
Failed buyer audit on traceability	Can't reconstruct which raw material lot went into a batch	Implement a batch-linked digital records (Section 3, Crawl stage)
Price quoted doesn't reflect FTA tariff	CoO process not factored into commercial offer	Confirm CoO eligibility and cost before quoting; build it into your

20-Point Export Readiness Scorecard

Score each statement: 0 = Not in place, 1 = Partially in place, 2 = Fully in place. Add up your total out of 40.

#	Statement	Score (0-2)
1	We have an active IEC and GST export/LUT registration	
2	We know the correct HS codes for our main export products	
3	We have a documented CoO process for at least one target FTA market	
4	Our commercial invoice and packing list formats are standardised	
5	We hold (or are actively pursuing) the quality certification our target buyers expect	
6	SOPs exist for our critical production and QC steps	
7	Incoming material inspection records are kept and retrievable by batch	
8	Final pre-shipment QC checklists are used consistently	
9	Calibration records for test/measuring equipment are current	
10	A non-conformance / corrective action process is documented	
11	Production and inventory records exist in structured digital form	
12	Each batch has a unique identifier traceable across production, QC and dispatch	
13	We can answer 'where did this batch's materials come from' within minutes	
14	Quality records are tagged to the same batch IDs as production records	
15	Export documents can be assembled from existing records with minimal re-typing	
16	We understand which FTAs apply to our products and target markets	
17	Our pricing models account for FTA tariff benefits where applicable	
18	We have a banking/AD Code setup ready for export transactions	
19	We understand RoDTEP / Duty Drawback and have assigned someone to claims	
20	A specific person on our team owns export readiness end-to-end	

0-15: Crawl — Foundational digitisation needed before pursuing export orders at scale.

16-25: Walk — Core pieces are in place; focus on connecting records and closing documentation gaps.

26-33: Run — Largely export-ready; tighten traceability and automate document assembly.

34-40: Fly — Strong export readiness; focus on FTA optimisation and scaling to new markets.



Next Step: A Free Technology Readiness Assessment

Working through this playbook gives you an honest internal view of where your unit stands. A Kinexus Technology Readiness Assessment (TRA) goes one step further — a Kinexus consultant visits your facility, reviews your current systems against this checklist, and identifies the single highest-leverage 6-week sprint to close your biggest gaps.

Manufacturing units in Punjab, Haryana or Himachal Pradesh with 10–500 employees qualify for a complimentary 2-hour on-site TRA.

Book your free TRA: www.kinexussystems.com/#contact

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